

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineering Consultant

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineering Consultant with over five years of hands-on experience delivering specialist security engineering and operations consultancy across enterprise environments. I have deep expertise in designing and implementing Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms — particularly Microsoft Sentinel — and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) solutions including CrowdStrike Falcon, enabling customers to mature their Security Operations Centre (SOC) functions, automate detection and response workflows, and improve overall security posture. I am highly proficient in Kusto Query Language (KQL), Security Orchestration, Automation, and Response (SOAR) playbook development, and detection engineering, and I bring a strong consulting mindset that combines technical depth with the ability to translate complex security requirements into practical, scalable solutions. I am equally experienced in vulnerability management, exposure management, and process automation, and I thrive on helping organisations close coverage gaps and embed operational best practice.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Implementation and Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel — workspace design, data connectors, analytics rules, workbooks, and Kusto Query Language (KQL) authoring; CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM
- **XDR / Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM) — expert-level deployment, management, and optimisation across hybrid environments
- **SOAR / Detection Engineering:** SOAR playbook development and automation; detection rule authoring and tuning; alert triage and escalation workflows; CrowdStrike Falcon Fusion SOAR
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender — large-scale deployment and management
- **Vulnerability and Exposure Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Nessus; risk-based remediation prioritisation
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO); BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL; SOAR workflow design and automation
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK framework; senior escalation lead; playbook authoring
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Additional Tooling:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony, Tanium, Microsoft Intune, Splunk

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Deliver specialist security engineering across SIEM, XDR, and SOAR platforms — designing, implementing, and continuously improving detection and response capabilities for a complex hybrid environment
- Architect and maintain Microsoft Sentinel SIEM workspace: data connector design, analytics rule creation, workbook development, and KQL-based threat hunting queries and dashboards
- Engineer and manage the CrowdStrike Falcon XDR platform — optimising detection policies, configuring prevention and insight modules, and building NG-SIEM detection content
- Develop and operationalise SOAR playbooks in CrowdStrike Falcon Fusion and Microsoft Sentinel, automating alert triage, enrichment, and containment workflows to reduce mean time to respond

- Lead detection engineering: author, test, and tune SIEM and EDR detection rules mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, closing coverage gaps across endpoint, identity, cloud, and email telemetry
- Serve as senior escalation lead for security incidents, conducting structured investigations under NIST 800-61 and producing post-incident reports with lessons learned and remediation recommendations
- Drive vulnerability and exposure management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS; produce risk-based remediation plans presented to senior stakeholders
- Collaborate with infrastructure teams to integrate security tooling into hybrid cloud and on-premises environments, advising on security architecture and control implementation

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 – March 2025*

- Deployed and configured CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across the university estate, building a hybrid SOC capability from the ground up and establishing detection and response processes
- Configured Microsoft Sentinel data connectors, analytics rules, and workbooks; authored KQL queries to hunt for threats and investigate security events across cloud and on-premises environments
- Designed and implemented SOAR automation playbooks, reducing manual effort in alert triage and accelerating incident containment
- Performed SIEM alert triage, root-cause analysis, and threat hunting across endpoint, email, identity, and cloud telemetry
- Managed vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, tracking findings through to remediation and reporting risk metrics to the security leadership team
- Administered Azure AD / Entra ID Conditional Access policies, MFA, and SSO — hardening identity and access controls across 8,000 users
- Authored and maintained incident response playbooks aligned to NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK, ensuring consistent and repeatable response procedures

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 – March 2022*

- Managed endpoint security tooling, identity access controls, and infrastructure security across a SaaS FinTech environment
- Performed security alert monitoring and triage, escalating incidents and supporting remediation activities
- Supported ISO 27001 compliance activities including risk assessments, access reviews, and security policy documentation
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and coordinated remediation with infrastructure and development teams
- Automated routine security tasks using PowerShell, reducing manual overhead and improving operational consistency

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed a full CrowdStrike Falcon XDR and NG-SIEM implementation across a large hybrid estate, establishing SOC detection and response capabilities from scratch and enabling proactive threat hunting
- Built a comprehensive SOAR playbook library in CrowdStrike Falcon Fusion and Microsoft Sentinel, automating key response workflows and significantly reducing mean time to respond to critical alerts
- Authored a suite of KQL-based Microsoft Sentinel analytics rules and workbooks, improving threat detection coverage across endpoint, cloud, identity, and email data sources
- Led Cyber Essentials Plus certification programme, remediating vulnerability findings and hardening endpoint and identity controls across the enterprise
- Delivered a Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) programme to continuously validate security control effectiveness and prioritise remediation based on real-world attack paths
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) at 8,000-user scale, significantly improving visibility into endpoint and identity-based threats

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering

- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 75,000–87,000 | Hybrid (UK)